

104. 为什么都写 3 | Why Is 3 Written the Same Way?

2026-08-30 · 英语 English · 阿拉伯数字 Arabic numerals

孩子看到中文和英文都写数字 3，父亲解释阿拉伯数字全球通用，但读音不同。

The child notices that the number 3 is written the same way in Chinese and English. The child's father explains that Arabic numerals are used worldwide but pronounced differently.

Speakers: A - 父亲 father | B - 孩子 child

B: 为什么我们这里是 3，英文里也是 3?

wèi shén me wǒ men zhè lǐ shì sān, yīng wén lǐ yě shì sān?

Why is it written as 3 in both Chinese and English?

如当前对话会分别显示中文、拼音和英文，但其中的数字都写成 3。

This dialogue is shown in Chinese, pinyin, and English, but the number is written as 3 in all three.

A: 阿拉伯数字是全球通用的。

ā lā bó shù zì shì quán qiú tōng yòng de.

Arabic numerals are used all over the world.

A: 都是写 3。但中文读 “sān” (三)，英文读 /θri:/ (three)。

dōu shì xiě sān. dàn zhōng wén dú “sān” (sān) , yīng wén dú /θri:/ (three) .

They're both written as 3. In Chinese, it's pronounced "sān" (三), and in English, it's pronounced /θri:/ (three).

字写的都是 3，但读音不一样。

It's written as 3 in both languages, but it's pronounced differently.

A: 你知道 0、1、2 叫作阿拉伯数字吧?

nǐ zhī dào líng, yī, èr jiào zuò ā lā bó shù zì ba?

You know that 0, 1, and 2 are Arabic numerals, right?

B: 知道。

zhī dào.

Yeah.

SceneTalk Mandarin

SceneTalk Mandarin is designed for Mandarin beginners and travelers visiting China, helping you start speaking Chinese in real-life situations. It includes offline content such as scene-based dialogues, key expressions, cultural tips, background articles, and human-recorded Chinese audio, helping you learn common, natural Chinese expressions used in real communication.

The iOS app is available on the App Store in all regions outside mainland China.

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